



2018 KIA OPTIMA REVIEW: GLIMPSES OF A BRIGHT FUTURE

The Kia Optima will not be among the company's initial portfolio in India, but if this is an indication of what the brand has to offer, Kia Motors can well be one of the strongest brands of 2019.

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Kia Motors' announcement of its India launch was met with a whole lot of enthusiasm. Hyundai's sister brand has been a popular choice in international markets, and buoyed by Hyundai's success, has a very elaborate plan for India. It had the biggest show floor among all brands at the 2018 Auto Expo. The Kia Optima will possibly not be a part of the company's portfolio when it rolls its first cars out on to the road, but going by what it has on offer, we certainly hope that it does make it to India some time 'round.

DESIGN AND AESTHETICS

There is no other way to put it - the 2018 Kia Optima is one gorgeous set of wheels. The nose is sharp and flat, with the uniquely shaped, chrome-studded grill easily setting it apart from Hyundai's Fluidic design language.

The panoramic glass roof is tinted and insulated to prevent greenhouse effect inside the car, should you choose to retract the fabric sheath and have only the glass expanse above your head. Then there are the alloys - the 18-inch five twin-spoke wheels that fit the arches perfectly, and the chrome

strip running along the car's wheelbase further add definition to its design. The spillover LED tail lamps and the overall design of the car's rear end does look similar to a Hyundai (in particular, the 2018 Hyundai Sonata that is not sold in India right now). That said, it is still classy, and in the muted shade of titanium that we got the Optima in, makes for one classy piece of car design.

TECHNOLOGY AND ELECTRONICS

When it comes to the infotainment package, the Kia Optima has just about enough to provide you all the basics that